User-centered design is a design methodology and philosophy in which the needs, goals, and success of the end user are considered. User-centered design can be applied to any type of system, object or product intended for human use, but the term is used most frequently in connection with computer information system design. In user-centered design, the ease with which a system can be understood by its intended users, how easily they can complete tasks with it, and how satisfied they are with their use of it, become the key measures of the success of the design. User-centered designs typically require less documentation and training to be successfully used because they have been designed specifically to match the expectations and abilities of the users. Although user-centered design is closely associated with the discipline of user interface design, it can cover almost every aspect of a system, not only its user interface. Elements of a system such as its documentation, how data are entered and structured within the system and made available for use, how it is deployed and presented within an organization, and how the system use fits into the business goals of an organization, can all have user-centered design applied to them. The term “user-centered” design was made popular by Donald Norman, a cognitive scientist working in the field of system and product usability. He first referred to “user-centered system design” in 1986. His bestselling book, The Design of Everyday Things (Norman 1988) (originally published as the Psychology of Everyday Things), introduced the concept to a wide audience. Successful user interfaces meet users’ expectations. The application of human factors and ergonomic design principles result in displays and controls that are clearly visible and easy to interact with. User-centered design ensures that displays and controls make sense to the user. A key tenet of user-centered design is that to be intuitive the user interface should match the user’s mental model of the task they are performing. Norman gives the compelling and memorable example of the cooktop found in most kitchens. Cooktops typically have four cooking rings: two at the front nearest the user, and two at the back closer to the kitchen wall. However, the knobs with which the user controls the rings are often arranged in a straight line. This is a bad user interface for this system because there is no immediately obvious relationship (also called “mapping”) between the location of the knob and the location of the ring it controls. The spatial arrangement of the knobs does not match that of the rings they control. This basic user interface design flaw makes it hard to use the system and causes the user to frequently turn the wrong ring on. User-centered design recognizes that the user’s ability to understand how to use controls for the cooktop’s rings is an important design problem that must be solved before the cooktop is put into production for users to struggle with